

- The total number of marks for the paper is 60, with 30 marks for reading and 30 marks for writing.

Reading

Students will be required to read a range of authentic factual and non-factual written material of varying length, in different registers and contexts, and from different sources. These may include advertisements, short passages, letters, information leaflets, faxes, emails, website pages, newspaper and magazine articles. The texts will be related to the topic areas on page 11.

The aim of the reading tasks is to assess students' abilities in understanding and using information from a range of texts of increasing length.

The questions will require a combination of non-verbal responses and answers in French. In order to answer the questions, students will need to use a range of reading techniques such as skimming, scanning and in-depth reading for details. Grammatical accuracy will not be assessed in this part of the paper.

Assessment of the reading section

Students will be assessed on their ability to:

- identify and note main points
- deduce the meaning of words from context
- extract specific details

- identify points of view
- show some understanding of unfamiliar language
- recognise attitudes, emotions and opinions
- understand grammatical structures and functions, in context.

Question types in the reading section

A range of question types, written in the target language, will be used, which may include:

- grid, form or plan completion
- multiple choice
- true or false
- box ticking
- note taking
- gap filling
- matching, for example –
 - words from the text with synonyms, antonyms or definitions
 - summary sentences with different paragraphs of the text
 - two halves of one sentence
 - ideas or sequences with pictures
 - a named person with a statement
- summary.

Writing

In the first extended writing task (question 3b), students will be required to write about 50 words in the target language, on a topic related to the preceding reading passage. The response will be assessed for communication and content and knowledge and application of language according to the assessment criteria on page 12.

For the second piece of extended writing (question 6), students will select **one** writing task from a choice of three. They will be expected to write a continuous response, of about 150 words, in French. Students aiming at grade C and above will be expected to express opinions and to use a variety of structures, including a range of tenses.

The tasks for question 6 will encompass a variety of writing styles, such as narrative, descriptive, discursive, and a range of formats such as a formal or informal letter, a report, an article, a page from a diary, the script of a speech etc.

The 20 marks available for question 6 will be sub-divided into 10 marks for communication and content, 5 marks for knowledge and application of language, and 5 marks for accuracy. This question is marked according to the assessment criteria on page 13.

Detailed instructions for the conduct of this paper are available in *Appendix 2: Instructions for the conduct of examinations (Papers 1 and 2)*.

Paper 3: Speaking

Assessment overview

- Maximum 10 minutes.
- The total number of marks for the paper is 40 (20 marks for Section A, 20 marks for Section B).

The speaking test will recognise the achievement of the student in speaking the target language.

The test will be divided into **two** sections. Each student chooses the topic area for Section A; the centre-appointed interviewer chooses **two** additional topic areas for the two conversations in Section B. Overall, each student will have covered three of the five topic areas listed on page 11. Edexcel will review each candidate cover sheet (see *Appendix 4: Candidate cover sheet (Paper 3)*) to ensure that a range of topics has been covered.

Section A: Presentation and discussion based on a single picture

- Maximum four minutes:
 - Presentation: maximum of one minute.
 - Discussion: maximum of three minutes.

Students will give a presentation for up to **one minute** on a picture they have chosen. A discussion with the centre-appointed interviewer will then follow, for up to **three minutes**. The discussion must relate to the picture, but may also include some questions prompted by the picture the student has chosen.

Stage 1 – Teaching and Learning

As part of the teaching and learning phase for this assessment, each student must choose a single picture based on a topic area from page 11 in advance of the speaking exam. The student must write the relevant topic area on the back of the picture. The picture may be a photograph or a drawing.

The pictures chosen should reflect students' interests. They may, for example, be family photographs (copies or originals), or pictures of sporting or school events. They may be chosen from newspapers or magazines. The pictures should include objects, people and interaction, and should allow students to demonstrate their speaking proficiency appropriately. Pictures containing written text, which may give students assistance in the discussion, are **not** allowed. It is expected that the candidates' presentations within a centre will usually reflect a range of topic areas.

Note: The theme of the pictures can be the same for an entire teaching cohort, but each picture must be different.

The pictures provided in Section A of the Sample Assessment Material are for illustrative purposes only and must not be used for the examination.

The examples can be found in the *Sample Assessment Materials* document on the website (www.edexcel.com).

Stage 2 – Preparation

During the preparation phase, the teacher can:

- introduce various topics
- give guidance on how and where to research for necessary information
- give advice on the appropriateness of the pictures chosen as related to the topic chosen

However, teachers (and language assistants) cannot:

- provide information and content of picture presentation/introduction (this should be candidate's own work)
- give feedback on the content of presentation prepared by the candidate
- reveal questions that are to be asked at the exam.

The student must provide a copy of the picture for the centre-appointed interviewer in advance of the test. If it is in colour, a clear black and white copy for the centre-appointed interviewer is acceptable.

Stage 3 – Assessment

There will be no preparation time for the exam on the day of the examination. Students **must not** take notes into the exam. **The candidate must not be able to predict exactly what will be asked during the exam or in what order.**

The objectives of this assessment are to:

- describe the picture
- take part in a discussion that relates to the picture.

Students aiming at grade C or above will be required to:

- give a personal interpretation of the scene
- express opinions
- use a variety of language and structures
- respond imaginatively to the picture
- discuss issues arising from the content of the picture.

The 20 marks available for this question are sub-divided into 10 marks for presentation, communication and fluency, 5 marks for knowledge and application of language, and 5 marks for accuracy. This question is marked according to the assessment criteria on pages 14-15.

A copy of the picture must be attached to each student's cover sheet (see *Appendix 4: Candidate cover sheet (Paper 3)*) before being sent to the Edexcel examiner with the audio files. If the picture cannot be sent, a description of the picture must be attached to the candidate cover sheet.

Section B: Two conversations

- Maximum six minutes.
- Centre-appointed interviewers should ensure that the time is split evenly between the two topic areas (approximately 3 minutes for each topic).

Students will take part in conversations with the centre-appointed interviewer on **two** separate topic areas. These topic areas will be different from the topic area chosen by the student for Section A. Section B will last up to a maximum of **six minutes**, with approximately three minutes for each conversation.

Note: The centre-appointed interviewer must ensure that two separate topic areas are covered in Section B by ticking the topic area covered and writing the title of the sub-topic covered in each conversation on the candidate cover sheet (see *Appendix 4: Candidate cover sheet (Paper 3)*).

Throughout Section B, the centre-appointed interviewer should encourage genuine interaction by adopting a question and answer format. The centre-appointed interviewer should ask questions which are clear, precise and varied, to ensure that individual students demonstrate their potential. To ensure that students are given the opportunity to demonstrate their linguistic skills at the appropriate level, guidance on the types of questions to be asked are available in the *Sample Assessment Materials* document available on the Edexcel website (www.edexcel.com). These sample questions show how a conversation may be developed. The questions are not prescriptive, and should not be asked in a pre-arranged order. The aim is to engage in a spontaneous and authentic conversation.

In both conversations in Section B, centre-appointed interviewers will be free to develop any area within their chosen topic from the list given on page 11. For example, a student asked to speak on the *Education and employment* topic could focus on one sub-topic, such as *School*.

The conversations must not be rehearsed before the test.

Conversation 1

The first conversation will be based on a topic area or sub-topic area, chosen by the centre-appointed interviewer, from page 11.

The first conversation must be chosen from a different topic area from that chosen by the student in Section A of the test.

In order to achieve grade C and above, students will be expected to express opinions and use a variety of structures, including a range of tenses.

Conversation 2

The second conversation will also be based on a topic area or sub-topic area, chosen by the centre-appointed interviewer, from page 11.

The second conversation must be from a different topic area from that chosen by the student in Section A of the test, and also different from that chosen by the centre-appointed interviewer in Conversation 1, Section B, of the test.

As in the first conversation, in order to achieve grade C and above, students will be expected to express opinions and use a variety of structures, including a range of tenses.

The 20 marks available for this part of the assessment are sub-divided into 10 marks for communication, interaction and fluency, 5 marks for knowledge and application of language, and 5 marks for accuracy. This question is marked according to the assessment criteria on pages 16-17.

Assessment arrangements

All speaking tests will be recorded on a date chosen by the centre during the period specified annually by Edexcel. This period is from mid-March up to and including the date of the written examinations.

The test will be conducted by the centre-appointed interviewer. This will normally be a teacher of the target language from the centre, but could also be someone from outside the centre.

Both the teacher and the candidate must sign the declaration of authentication on the candidate cover sheet (see *Appendix 4: Candidate cover sheet (Paper 3)*), confirming that the work is the candidate's own. Any candidate unable to provide an authentication statement will receive zero credit for the component.

Centres are responsible for providing their own CDs or USBs, on to which the orals should be saved. **CDs or USBs must be clearly labelled.**

Individual candidate cover sheets (which give students' details and the topics covered) and the orals must be despatched directly to the Edexcel examiner on the day on which the tests are conducted.

All speaking tests will be externally marked by Edexcel.

Detailed instructions for the conduct of the speaking test are available in *Appendix 3: Instructions for the conduct of examinations (Paper 3)*.

Topic areas

All questions will be set in the context of the following topic areas and sub-topic areas. These will enable students and teachers to focus on appropriate vocabulary.

Topic areas	Sub-topic areas
Topic area A Home and abroad	Life in the town and rural life Weather and climate Travel, transport and directions Holidays and tourist information Services (eg telephone, bank, post office) Customs and religion Everyday life, traditions and communities in a French-speaking country
Topic area B Education and employment	Childhood School life and routine Work/careers Future plans
Topic area C House, home and daily routines	Types of home Information about self, family and friends Helping around the house Food and drinks
Topic area D The modern world and the environment	Current affairs and social issues Environmental issues The media (eg TV, film, radio, newspapers) Information and communication technology (eg internet, mobile phones, email)
Topic area E Social activities, fitness and health	Special occasions Hobbies, interests, sports and exercise Shopping and money matters Accidents, injuries, common ailments and health issues

Linguistic structures

Students are expected to have acquired knowledge and understanding of French grammar during their course. In the examination, students will be required to apply their knowledge and understanding to various tasks, drawing from the list given in *Appendix 1: Linguistic structures for French*.

Assessment criteria

Students are assessed positively in all components, and therefore the assessment criteria are designed to reward, not penalise. It will not be necessary for students to produce a faultless performance in order to attract the highest marks available in each grid.

Major errors

These may include **repeated** mismatching of subject and verb forms; use of inappropriate tenses; and/or incorrect and inappropriate vocabulary.

Minor errors

These may include **occasional** omission of accents; incorrect genders, articles, auxiliary verbs or adjectival agreements; slight spelling errors.

Paper 2: Reading and Writing – Question 3(b)

Communication and content	Mark
No rewardable material.	0
- Little meaningful communication; only occasionally comprehensible. - Most of the response may have been copied from the supporting passage without any attempt to adapt it.	1–2
- Limited communication; frequently lacking clarity. - Some of the response may have been copied from the supporting passage but with some attempt to adapt it.	3–4
- Mostly clear communication with some ambiguity. - The candidate's response is mostly independent; minimal reliance on the supporting passage.	5

Knowledge and application of language	Mark
No rewardable material.	0
- Narrow range of basic vocabulary and structures. - Minimal accuracy in spelling and grammar.	1–2
- Adequate range of vocabulary and structures, with some repetition. - Some accuracy in spelling and grammar with errors.	3–4
- Good range of vocabulary and structures. - General accuracy in spelling and grammar, although there may be errors.	5

Paper 2: Reading and Writing – Question 6

Communication and content	Mark
• No rewardable material.	0
• Little meaningful communication; only occasionally comprehensible. • The response is barely relevant to the task.	1–2
• Limited communication; frequently lacking clarity. • The response is partially relevant to the task but there may be major omissions.	3–4
• Mostly clear communication with some ambiguity. • The response is mostly relevant and addresses some aspects of the task.	5–6
• Clear communication with occasional ambiguity. • The response is relevant and addresses most aspects of the task.	7–8
• Clear communication with no ambiguity. • The response is relevant and fully addresses all aspects of the task.	9–10

Knowledge and application of language	Mark
• No rewardable material.	0
• Narrow range of basic vocabulary and structures. • Very little use of tenses to vary sentences.	1–2
• Adequate range of vocabulary and structures, with some repetition. • Some use of tenses to vary sentences.	3–4
• Uses wide range of vocabulary and structures, including some complex lexical items. • Use of a range of tenses to vary sentences.	5

Accuracy	Mark
• No rewardable material.	0
• Very little evidence of correct verb formation, gender and agreement. • Correct spelling is limited.	1–2
• Some evidence of correct verb formation, gender and agreement. • Spelling is accurate for some of the response.	3–4
• Strong evidence of correct verb formation, gender and agreement. • Spelling is generally accurate although there may be occasional lapses.	5